

SQL Triggers

23 · Triggers — Complete Reference Guide

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SQL Trigger — AFTER INSERT Example

A trigger fires automatically when a specified event (INSERT/UPDATE/DELETE) occurs on a table.

Step 1: Create the Log Table

```
CREATE TABLE Sales.EmployeeLogs
(
    LogID          INT IDENTITY(1,1) PRIMARY KEY,
    EmployeeID     INT,
    LogMessage     VARCHAR(255),
    LogDate        DATE
);
GO
```

Step 2: Create the AFTER INSERT Trigger on Employees

```
CREATE TRIGGER trg_AfterInsertEmployee
ON Sales.Employees
AFTER INSERT
AS
BEGIN
    INSERT INTO Sales.EmployeeLogs (EmployeeID, LogMessage, LogDate)
    SELECT
        EmployeeID,
        'New Employee Added = ' + CAST(EmployeeID AS VARCHAR),
        GETDATE()
    FROM INSERTED;
END;
```

GO

Step 3: Insert a New Employee — this fires the trigger

```
INSERT INTO Sales.Employees  
VALUES (6, 'Maria', 'Doe', 'HR', '1988-01-12', 'F', 80000, 3);  
GO
```

Step 4: Verify the trigger wrote to the log table

```
SELECT *  
FROM Sales.EmployeeLogs;  
GO
```